

Block 2 — Theories of Personality I (Psychodynamic · Social Cognitive · Learning · Humanistic)

Freud — Psychoanalytic Theory

Structure

Topographical: Conscious (~10%), Preconscious (~10–15%), Unconscious (~75–80%). Iceberg.

Structural: **Id** (pleasure principle, unconscious), **Ego** (reality principle, mediates), **Superego** (ego-ideal + conscience, all levels).

Instincts: **Eros** (life/love) + **Thanatos** (death). **Libido** = psychic energy.

Defense Mechanisms

Denial, Repression, Regression, Reaction formation, Projection, Rationalisation, Intellectualisation, Displacement, **Sublimation** (most adaptive).

Psychosexual Stages

Stage	Age	Zone/Key
Oral	0–18mo	Mouth; fixation→smoking, dependent
Anal	18mo–3yr	Anus; retentive→perfectionist, expulsive→messy
Phallic	3–6yr	Genitals; Oedipus/Electra, castration anxiety, identification
Latency	6yr–puberty	Dormant libido; same-sex play
Genital	puberty+	Sexual urges reawaken; opposite-sex peers

Evaluation

Merits: complete theory, unconscious, defense mechanisms. Demerits: lacking empirical evidence, over-emphasis on sex, psychic determinism.

Karen Horney (1885–1952)

Basic anxiety = isolated/helpless in hostile world. **Basic evil** → **basic hostility**.

10 neurotic needs. 3 coping strategies: Compliance (moving-toward), Aggression (moving-against), Withdrawal (moving-away-from).

Theory of Self: Real self vs Ideal self → "tyranny of the should," "search for glory." **Womb envy**. Opposed penis envy. **Neo-Freudian**.

Sullivan (died 1949) — Interpersonal Theory

Interpersonal model (vs Freud's drive model). **3 levels of cognition:** Prototaxic, Parataxic, Syntaxic.

Self-system = most inclusive dynamism. Security operations: dissociation, selective inattention.

3 personifications: Good-me, Bad-me, Not-me.

7 developmental epochs: Infancy→Childhood→Juvenile→Pre-adolescence→Early adolescence→Late adolescence→Adulthood. Timing dictated by social environment.

Euphoria = no anxiety. Anxiety = chief disruptive force. "Mothering one."

Bandura — Social Cognitive Theory

Triadic reciprocal determinism: $P \leftrightarrow B \leftrightarrow E$. "People are both products and producers of their environment."

Self-efficacy = belief in one's capabilities. **4 sources:** (1) Mastery experiences (most effective), (2) Social modeling, (3) Social persuasion, (4) Psychological responses.

Bobo Doll Experiment: children imitated aggression without reward → contradicted behaviourism.

4 steps of modeling: Attentional → Retentional → Reproduction → Motivational.

Vicarious learning. Symbolic modeling.

Limitations: behaviour more consistent than theory suggests; biological factors ignored; theory not unified.

Pavlov — Classical Conditioning

UCS→UCR; CS paired with UCS→CR. **Acquisition** (pairings + interval ~0.5s).

Generalisation, Discrimination, Extinction, Spontaneous recovery. Higher-order conditioning.

Experimental neurosis (Shenger-Krestovnika, 1921): circle vs ellipse discrimination breakdown.

Applications: Systematic desensitisation, flooding, aversion therapy, counter-conditioning.

Skinner — Operant Conditioning

Operant (voluntary) vs **Respondent** (involuntary). **Reinforcer** (positive/negative). **Aversive** = punishment.

Schedules: Continuous, Fixed ratio, Fixed interval, **Variable ratio, Variable interval (most resistant to extinction)**.

Shaping = successive approximation. **Superstitious behaviour** (no causal relationship).

Token economy.

Criticisms: Chomsky (1959) — language not explained. Boulding (1984) — animal principles may not apply. Not comprehensive personality theory. Biological factors ignored.

Maslow — Hierarchy of Needs

"**Third Force**" (vs psychodynamic + behaviourist). Holistic. Focus on potentials.

5 levels: Physiological → Safety → Belongingness → Esteem (lower=respect of others, higher=self-respect) → **Self-actualisation**.

D-needs (deficiency; first 4; homeostasis). **B-needs** (being/growth; self-actualisation; continuous).

Self-actualisers: reality-centered, problem-centered, autonomous, unhostile humour, peak experiences, democratic value, creativity, resist enculturation. Imperfections: realistic anxiety, ruthlessness, metapathologies.

Criticism: methodology (biographical analysis); ~2% achieve; constraints on self-actualisation (Goldstein & Rogers disagree).

Rogers — Person-Centered / Self Theory

Self = organised perceptions of who I am. **Real self** vs **Ideal self**. **Congruence** = healthy; incongruence = anxiety.

Unconditional positive regard (vs conditional). **Fully functioning person:** open to experience, existential, trusts organism, creative, harmonious.

3 therapeutic conditions: Genuineness, Unconditional positive regard, Empathic understanding.

Key books: *Client-Centered Therapy* (1951), *On Becoming a Person* (1961).